

FAMILY TIES
KCR with daughter and Nizamabad MLC K. Kavitha

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in the US, employed there and were leading a good life. But they came back and joined the agitation. They even went to jail. And they were elected democratically after that. This *parivar* business is all rubbish.

Q. Yet Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the BJP are raising the issue of *parivarvaad*?
He is a liar. The BJP gives tickets to so many parivars. They made Yediyurappa's son BJP state chief in Karnataka recently. Where was the *parivarvaad* then, Mr Modi?

Q. The PM, at a recent campaign meeting in Nizamabad, claimed you had approached him to join the NDA in 2021. Is it true?
What can I do if he says whatever comes to his mind and makes up convenient stories? The fact is, I am a CM, he is the PM. I need to maintain minimum state-Centre relations. They did ask me to join (the NDA). But I said, first you do something good for the state, then maybe. But they are not doing anything good for Telangana. If Modi wasn't the prime minister, the state's per capita income would have grown to Rs 4 lakh—he is stopping so many things. When Modi was CM, he complained against the Centre. But now his own governors are blocking bills even after the legislature has given its assent. This is criminal. The Telangana governor [Tamilisai Soundararajan] is the former president of the Tamil Nadu unit of the BJP. She is playing silly, third-class politics by holding up so many bills.

Q. Modi also said you sought his blessings for your son to succeed you in the state.
If there is a private conversation and I say that when I turn 70, I may think of retiring as I have done 50 years in politics, should you reveal it to the public? Then, he enquired about KTR (his son). So, I told him since you are the prime minister, do give him your blessings and cooperate with him. Is it fit for the PM to reveal such personal conversations on a political dais?

> **"THE CASE AGAINST KAVITHA IS COCK-AND-BULL, 100 PER CENT VINDICTIVE BY THE BJP. WE WILL FIGHT IT IN COURT. THE LIQUOR POLICY OF DELHI WAS DONE OPENLY. WHERE IS THE SCAM IN IT?"**

Q. How would you assess the PM's performance?
It's been 100 per cent disastrous. Everything is going downwards. See the value of the Indian rupee—it has never been so low. It touched Rs 83.4 to the dollar. Then, 50 per cent of the industry in the country has closed down. Previously, it was brain drain, now it is capital drain. Investors are running out of the country as are people, in lakhs, not in thousands.

Q. But the prime minister says we're the world's fastest-growing economy.
That is rubbish, including his claims of making it a Rs 5 trillion economy. Out of our 140 crore population, about 60 per cent are young. There is no *kaam*, no *daam*. Do you see any good work being done for the Dalits, tribals, OBCs, or farmers?

Q. The RSS and BJP propound Hindutva. What is your dharma?
I am a staunch Hindu, I perform yagnas openly. My approach is—be Hindu, but don't bring Hindutva into politics. You are insulting Hindutva if you take it to the bazaar to encash it politically.

Q. Amit Shah came here and said he will make someone from the Backward Classes the chief minister if the BJP wins.
The BJP will not get more than one or two seats, the party can say anything it wants.

Q. You had said at the early stage of the Telangana struggle that you wanted to make a Dalit the first CM of the state?
Yes, I did say that. But the way Telangana happened, we had only 63 MLAs and everyone advised that it is not possible for others to run the new state. We have not gone back on the promise. Let the time come for it.